

your entire music collection and quite a number of videos to entertain you while travelling.

Hardware

“But why should I pay ₹32,000 for a laptop with a Core i3 processor when I can get a Core i5 for only ₹38,000?” Does that sound familiar? To many of us at Digit, it does – not only are we asked such questions daily by friends and their friends but also by readers on Facebook and Thinkdigit forums and in our inboxes. So is a Core i5 based machine worth its price or would a Core i3 suffice? How about a Core i7? Let’s explore.

Processors

If we were to have genies to fulfil our wishes, we’d wish for more powerful laptops! While we may not have genies, we do have processors which can grant our requests for souped up computing devices. These little wonders let us do things such as satisfy the insatiable urge to accelerate a car in the virtual world. While this feat is surely impressive, the processor is also responsible for the most basic of tasks. It’s the primary chip at the core of every laptop determining the speed at which your device will work. Next time you see an advertisement for computing devices, notice how much emphasis is placed on the processors they flaunt. However, you should know that they don’t determine the entire computing performance. Let’s dig deeper to know what this means.

Processors have one job: to process data. When you open a document to edit or launch a browser to flip through Facebook, the load the processor experiences is minimal and for a short while. Scrolling through web pages and documents doesn’t put any significant load on the system but when you want to use the same piece of magic to convert music or video files for playback on your mobile devices, you put heavy load on it. When it boils down to the question of selecting processors, it’s imperative to ask yourself “what do I need from the machine?”. “Everything” is not the right answer to the question for two reasons:

1. **Expense:** The more you want in a device, the more cash you’ll have to shell out and you probably won’t even need the features in an expensive gadget. Unless you’re planning on editing a lot of HD video or playing very high-end PC games, you can save your money for better investments.
2. **Usage patterns:** We all have usage patterns. Developers will most likely use IDEs and command line, while administrators would need a good